

Plasto & Company
Livestock and Property

Livestock
Ross Plasto
0428 636 289

Property Management
Emma Cenzato
0418 636 254

Raine and Horne
Rural Properties
Ross Plasto
0428 636 289

Residential
Gary Francis
0428 459 830

Wellington & District

LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Eucharéena, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbron and Yeoval districts.

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Inc GST


WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

Wellington Boot Carnival

Friday 10 April
Sunday 12 April

Mumbil’s busker



Amalia Howard
‘One to Watch’
- P 4

Stuart Town swimmers



excel at carnival
- P 17

Walmer Post Office -



a bit more history
P 17

Exposing the effects of

a dreaded disease

SUFFERING FROM endometriosis is not going to stop Clair Stiff from enjoying life. In fact, she is devoting her university studies to gain as much knowledge as possible of how it is affecting rural women and how are they dealing with the disease. “As part of my Honours degree program I am exploring the experiences of endometriosis with women in regional, rural and remote areas who work in agricultural industries,” she said. Her studies into this condition has been enhance by her passion for women’s health. “Dealing with the disease myself and seeing the effects on agricultural lifestyle as well as managing this disease made me want to delve into the disease and its effects on rural women,” she said. “There’s no real presence of articles in the media describing what the experience looks or feels like and the effect the disease has on women out here. “So, I decided to direct her research towards rural women through this survey.” The survey started before Christmas and it is still open. “It basically is touching base with women and their role in agriculture – what their agricultural context looks like, where they work, if they work on-farm or in the agribusiness sector or other areas,” Clair said. The survey asks for their experience with endometriosis through more of a quantitative scale and then merging those together for some real raw questions, asking the participants to say whatever they would like about how the disease has affected their work life. “From this information I will be able to analyse all the data and then publish a Paper by the end of the year. “I have two supervisors through Charles Sturt University helping me.” Clair said she had already received a “massive response”. “It’s really great, but I would love to get a few more people involved” she said.

Women who would like to contribute to the survey just need to go onto Clair’s social media, facebook or Instagram on: clair_stiff and follow the link to her survey directory. The survey will close after the first week of March. **Wellington’s 2025 Woman of the Year** The whole of Wellington is right behind Clair Stiff as she prepares for the Zone 6 Finals of The Land Newspaper 2026 Woman of the Year competition, with finalists attending the grand judging and announcement during this year’s Sydney Royal Show. Preparations are also ongoing for the 150th Wellington Show’s Young Woman event where it is hoped as many previous ‘Showgirls’ will return for the celebration Show on May 16. Entries for this year’s Young Woman contest are now open. Contact the Wellington Show Society.

Endometriosis Endometriosis is when body tissue similar to the uterus lining (endometrium) grows outside the uterus. It usually grows in the pelvis but can occur in almost any part of the body. The hormone oestrogen can cause this tissue to grow and break down when you have your period. This can lead to pain and inflammation. There can also be scarring, causing organs to stick together (known as adhesions). Endometriosis is a progressive and chronic condition, meaning it gets worse over time. It can be very painful and can affect fertility. In Australia, around one in nine females develops endometriosis and can experience symptoms even after menopause. There is no cure for endometriosis but there are treatments to relieve symptoms.



Wellington Show Young Woman 2025, Clair Stiff is preparing for The Land Sydney Royal Show Young Woman Zone 6 Finals at Eugowra on Saturday, February 28. In the meantime Clair is conducting a survey among rural women suffering from endometriosis to finalise her University Honours degree at Charles Sturt University.

Council’s Mobility Plan comes under question

A MAJOR concern has been raised with Dubbo Regional Council following the release of a report for public display last Wednesday. In a **Binjang Community Radio** local news broadcast this week it was stated the in the report, the “**Dubbo and Wellington Pedestrian Access and Mobility Plan and Bike Plan**”, page 29, the population of Wellington suburb was miss-represented as being 4101 from the 2021 ABS Census Data, a figure which does not include residents living in Montefiores, or low-density housing blocks in Mt Arthur or Apsley. “Including all the residents in Wellington, the population according to the ABS statistics cited in Wikipedia is 5011, which is 22 per cent greater,” the report stated.

“The mistake throws into question the legitimacy of the report, particularly as to how fair and equitable allocation grants for Wellington could be applied to the building of infrastructure as part of any LGA funding as informed by the report. “This is the second known Dubbo Regional Council report in which the same flawed population statistics have appeared relating to the 2021 ABS statistics, despite being brought to the attention of council in the first instance by Councillor Richard Ivey. Dubbo Regional Council Mayor councilor Josh Black and Clr Richard Ivey expressed dismay at the situation, as it illustrates a spatial awareness disconnection between Greater Wellington and Council management in Dubbo ignoring raised concerns.”

As a major sponsor of the Wellington Show Young Woman of the Year contest, *Wellington & District Leader* encourages young women to enter the Show’s 150th anniversary contest by contacting Wellington Show Society on 0428 463 496

Inside this week

The adventures of ‘Blue Cap’ a leader among Wellington bushrangers. Read his story - Page 7

Road sealing program about to restart

Rain!
HOW WELCOME was that rain?! Obviously much more is needed, but it was very refreshing after a few heatwaves.

Annual Bitumen Resealing Program
Road resealing is a critical infrastructure program aimed at improving and extending the life of the Region’s road network.
It is much cheaper to reseal a road at \$7/m2 than to not do the work and have to rip up the entire road and re-lay it at \$70/m2.
Council is starting its annual bitumen resealing program this month. The work is expected to be completed by the end of April, weather permitting.
Resealing will occur in 58 locations across Wellington, Dubbo and the surrounding villages.
Residents on impacted urban and village roads will be notified at least three days before works start via a letterbox notice.
Residents living or travelling along the roads scheduled for resealing should expect minor delays during the works. Traffic management, including stop-and-slow, will

be on site for the duration.
To keep up to date on this project, and view the full list of roads being resealed, visit yoursay.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/dubbo-region-annual-road-reseal-program

Wellington Library Lego Club
Wellington Library is starting a new Lego program after school activity designed to spark creativity, build skills, and make afternoons more fun.
Lego Club in Wellington will be Tuesdays during the school terms 3:30pm to 5pm. Ages 5 – 12.
Contact the Library for more information.

HomeGround
The Western Plains Cultural Centre is calling for artists to apply for the next round of HomeGround, a professional development program for emerging artists.
HomeGround is designed for artists wanting to expand their skills, have the potential to extend their practice and benefit from the experience of working alongside curatorial staff within a professional gallery.
Eligible artists must live within a 200-

kilometre radius of Dubbo (which will make it roughly a 150km radius of Wellington).
HomeGround applications closes 10 April 2026. For information and application forms visit www.westernplainsculturalcentre.org or contact Natasha Lunniss on 6801 4444.

Bodangora Fund Reminder
Are you part of a community group in the Wellington District?
Applications are open for the Bodangora Wind Farm Community Benefit Fund with over \$68,000 available. Applications close on Saturday 28 February 2026.
Applications must be submitted via SmartGrants. No paper or email submission will be accepted. To apply visit dubbo.nsw.gov.au/funding.

Securing Dubbo Airport’s Future
Last week I was in Sydney for some meetings and one of those was to sign a Memorandum of Understanding as Chair of the Regional Capitals Group of Councils with the Australian Airports Association.

This MOU sets out an agreement to work together to advocate for fairer airfares, stronger connectivity and more sustainable airports across regional Australia.
With a Productivity Commission inquiry and a Senate inquiry both examining the future of regional aviation, 2026 is poised to be a pivotal year for regional air services.
Regional airports are the lifeblood of regional communities – critical to health, education, tourism, trade and disaster response and resilience.
Yet their financial viability is constantly under threat, and propped up by local government rates rather than state or federal funding sources.
Regional communities are paying not only higher average airfares but also for the costs of keeping airports open through their local rates.
Decisions made this year will likely shape the next decade, determining whether regional air services become more reliable, more equitable and more future-ready – or whether the current fragile state continues.
Josh Black

Expressions of interest request for positions on new Cultural Council - six seats available

COUNCIL (DRC) IS calling for Expressions of Interest to fill six positions on the new Cultural Council.
The Cultural Council will look at facilitating strategic conversations, connections and advocacy across the private sector and all levels of government in support of cultural development and access.
Mayor Josh Black said Council was looking for people to bring a fresh perspective.
“The Cultural Council will focus on how we can create connections across the region in different areas, focusing on the bigger picture, dynamic ideas and regional connections.
“The Cultural Council has been designed to be an advisory body to allow community members to discuss opportunities for regional cultural growth.
“While it won’t directly inform decisions of Council when it comes to decision-making for the community, those on the Cultural Council will be a link between our community and the elected body,” Clr Black said.
The Expression of Interest process will comprise of six community members selected for the body.
The Council will require two members from Social Services, which may include stakeholders from health services, community services, culturally and linguistically diverse communities, disability and aged services, and youth services.

Four members will come from regional creative practitioners and may include stakeholders from any creative, cultural or heritage service bodies, individual creative practitioners, event or program managers.
Priority will be given to applicants who demonstrate strong multi-sector or interagency engagement, with the Creative Council seeking representatives with diverse experiences across multiple groups or creative sectors.
To express your interest in joining the Cultural Council, visit the YourSay page: <https://yoursay.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/cultural-council-eoi>
Applications are open until March 17, 2026.

Minns loses control as Labor backs Water Royal Commission

THE STATE Labor Government has spectacularly contradicted its own Premier, voting in support of a motion calling for a Commonwealth Royal Commission into water management just hours after Chris Minns told the Legislative Assembly he did not back the proposal.
A Public Interest Debate was held in the NSW Parliament on a motion calling for a federal Royal Commission into water management, including the implementation of the Murray-Darling Basin Plan.
During Question Time earlier that day, the Premier made clear that he did not support renewed calls for a Royal Commission, yet the motion was passed unanimously by the House.
Shadow Minister for Water Steph Cooke said the stunning reversal exposed deep confusion and a lack of leadership at the heart of the NSW Labor Government.
“On one of the most critical issues facing regional New South Wales, the Premier said one thing in Question Time and his Government did the exact opposite on the floor of Parliament just hours later,” Ms Cooke said.
“This is not a minor slip-up, it is a glaring sign that the Government cannot keep its story straight on water,

which is the most important resource our communities rely on.”
“Unlike Labor, the Coalition is united in supporting a Commonwealth Royal Commission into Water Management after years of flawed policy and growing concern in basin communities.
“Protecting water for the environment does not have to come at the expense of farmers, who have already contributed more than any other group to delivering the Murray-Darling Basin Plan through on-farm efficiency works and buy-backs.
“When farmers have less water, it costs more to grow food, and NSW families feel that every time they stand at the supermarket checkout.
“That is the real-world impact of poor water policy.”

Funeral Notice

Veronica Mae Lay
Age 86
Late of Wellington

Much loved wife to Howard (dec)
Loving mother of Jennifer and Catherine
Adored Grandmother to Joshua
Cherished Great Grandmother to Timothy

Relatives and friends are warmly invited to attend
Veronica’s funeral service to be held at
St John the Baptist Anglican Church
Wellington
On Wednesday 18th February 2026, commencing at 11.30am
Followed by a private cremation
H Logue & Sons Funerals, Wellington NSW
0268451946

Funeral Notice

Julie Anne Ball
Aged 73 years
Late of Wellington

Much Loved Mother to Nicole, Kerstie, Damien, Richard and Luke (dec)
Cherished Grandmother and Great Grandmother
Loving Sister and Adored Aunty

Relatives and friends are warmly invited to attend
Julie’s funeral service, to be held at
The Wellington Bowling Club
on Friday 20th February 2026, Commencing at 11.00am
Followed by a private cremation
H Logue & Sons Funerals, Wellington NSW
0268451946

Wellington & District
LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O’Brien
Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Eucharéena to Elong Elong within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

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Editor: Mark Griggs
0456 940 999
email: mark@wdleader.news

Advertising Manager Sharon Wilson
0407 935 998
email: sharon@wdleader.news

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Bodangora Wind Farm grants open to Wellington region

APPLICATIONS HAVE opened for the Bodangora Wind Farm Community Benefit Fund.

The benefit fund is open to community groups in the Wellington district to support projects that provide a direct benefit to local communities in the area.

There is \$68,279.56 available for this year's round of the Bodangora Wind Farm Community Benefit Fund.

Mayor Josh Black said he encouraged community groups to consider projects or programs that would benefit from financial support.

"Grant programs like the Bodangora Wind Farm Community Benefit Fund play an important role in helping our community groups access the financial support they need to secure resources, deliver services, and run programs that strengthen and enrich our community," he said.

"I encourage all community groups across the Wellington region to consider the projects and initiatives they have planned for the next 12 months and to apply for funding to help bring those ideas to life."

Some of the organisations who have benefited from the fund in the past



Representatives of organisations who gained grants in the last fund round.

include the Wellington Warriors soccer club, Wellington Amateur Theatrical Society, Wellington Touch Association, Wellington Race Club, Wellington Public School P&C, Wellington Cowboys SLRC, Wellington Horse and Pony Club and Mid Macquarie Landcare.

Eligible community groups can apply for up to \$20,000 per application.

Only one application per organisation will be accepted.

Community groups can visit Council's website for the specific criteria and

determine if they are eligible to apply.

Applications are now open and close on Saturday 28 February 2026.

Applications must be made via SmartyGrants and will not be accepted via paper or email.

Eligible applications will be reviewed by an internal panel and considered by Councillors at a future meeting of Council.

For further information visit www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/funding

Power agreement delivers for NSW taxpayers

NSW TAXPAYERS will not spend a single dollar extending the operation of the Eraring power station, according to senior state government ministers including minister for energy Penny Sharpe.

Despite Coalition claims that keeping the privatised power station running would cost taxpayers \$3 billion, its operator has confirmed it will not seek public support through an underwriting arrangement struck nearly two years ago.

That means not a single taxpayer dollar will be spent and the lights will stay on.

Such an agreement would not have been necessary if the Coalition hadn't sold Eraring in 2013.

The NSW Government secured an agreement with Origin Energy in 2024 to underwrite Eraring until August 2027, to ensure energy reliability and avoid price spikes for households and businesses.

Last month, Origin notified the government, the Australian Stock Exchange and the Australian Energy Market Operator it planned to operate Eraring until April 2029.

This decision was independent of the existing underwriting agreement and does not lock the NSW Government into any further commitment.

Current energy security projections show NSW is expected to have sufficient energy supply by Eraring's anticipated closure in 2029, thanks to new renewable generation and storage coming online.

Domestic Violence NSW seeks just 0.01 per cent of state budget

NEW DATA released this week by Domestic Violence NSW (DVNSW) reveals specialist domestic and family violence (DFV) services across NSW are being pushed beyond breaking point, after more than a decade without any real increase to core funding.

Commissioned through Equity Economics, DVNSW's 'Unmet Demand' report shows the frontline sector is collapsing under the weight of rising need.

Two in three victim-survivors seeking help - most of them mothers with children - are now unable to be assigned a caseworker, leaving many to face escalating danger alone.

The findings come as NSW once again recorded the highest number of women killed in a domestic violence context nationally in 2025, while frontline services are being held together by little more than staff goodwill.

New DVNSW member survey data from late 2025 paints an even starker picture, showing services are support-

ing an average of 150 per cent more clients than they are funded for - with some operating at more than 900pc of state-funded capacity.

DVNSW CEO Delia Donovan said ignored calls for a 50pc increase to core funding have become more than a budget issue - they are now a political choice.

"Goodwill is not a funding model - it's exploitation," Ms Donovan said.

"The NSW Government must properly invest in frontline specialist DFV services - women and children's lives at risk. We live in one of the wealthiest and most well-resourced states in the country, yet women and children are being forced back into violence because we can't commit just 0.1pc of the state budget to the services that save their lives."

Ms Donovan said a year on from DVNSW's last report showing average wait times of two months for support across the state, the situation has continued to deteriorate.

The 'Unmet Demand report'

shows referrals have increased by more than 20pc across participating organisations, while the DFV workforce has shrunk due to funding cuts. To cope, staff are being forced to ration care - relying on waitlists, brief check-ins and external referrals even when no other service has capacity.

"Lack of capacity is putting victim-survivors in real danger," she said.

"When people are turned away, some stop reaching out altogether. Others continue to take enormous risks just to try and get help.

"Staff are paying for basic needs out of their own pockets, working unpaid overtime and fundraising in their own time just to keep women and children safe.

"Somewhere along the line, goodwill became a business model," Ms Donovan said. Domestic and family violence continues to rise across NSW, with more than 300 DFV-related assaults recorded every day across the state.

At the same time, soaring

housing costs and a shortage of crisis accommodation are trapping women and children in unsafe situations for longer.

While recent state government funding announcements have directed money to service expansions, contract renewals and Corrections, none have delivered a real uplift to the core funding of existing frontline specialist DFV services.

DVNSW is again calling for a 50pc increase to core funding - an investment of \$177.4 million.

"The data is clear.

The solutions are known. And in the context of the state budget, we're asking for crumbs. But the impact of inaction is life or Death," Ms Donovan said.

Pumped Hydro from Burrendong declared a state critical significant infrastructure

Two multi-billion-dollar renewable energy projects with the potential to power over one million homes in peak demand have been declared Critical State Significant Infrastructure (CSSI) by the state government.

Worth more than \$7 billion, the projects, if approved, would help secure the state's clean energy future.

The projects declared include \$3.6 billion Yarrabin (Phoenix) Pumped Hydro Project on Lake Burrendong near Mudgee, a ACEN Australia project which will have the capacity to power 600,000 homes.

The other is a \$3.5 billion Western Sydney Pumped Hydro Project at Lake Burrangorang, a ZEN Energy which will have the potential to power 500,000 homes. Both projects, are in the early planning stages and are located on WaterNSW land.

A comprehensive assessment will still be undertaken on each of the projects, including public exhibition and an opportunity for submissions from the community.

The government has approved more renewables projects in three years than the last 12 years combined.

Forty-four renewable energy projects have been approved since 2023 that, when built, will generate enough electricity to power 5.2 million homes.

There are currently more than 50 renewable energy, storage and transmission projects under assessment, and if approved, these 13.5 GW of generation projects could produce enough electricity to power about six million homes.

A further 196 projects, including solar, wind, battery storage and pumped hydro projects are at various stages in the planning pipeline.

Now open for 2026
Yoga with Catherine Thursdays 5.30pm
Seniors Tai Chi every Friday 9:30am
Open Sundays 1pm-4pm
Empathetic Counselling
by Appointment 6845 4661
 **Wellington Buddhist Centre**
Tharpa Choeling Australia

**One Stop Automotive Shop**
We Service New Cars and you get to keep the Warranty
We offer Pink/Green/Blue slips
Servicing new and old vehicles
Daniel Blackhall: 02 6845 4062 | 0439 589 860
Email: onestopautomotiveshop@hotmail.com
36A Gisborne Street, Wellington

**Pharmacists Recommends**
**Was \$15.99 - NOW \$12.49**
31 Nanima Crescent, Wellington
02 6845 2059
email: keirles@alliancepharmacy.com.au * Check us out on facebook

Letters to Editor

A Letter published last week was attributed to Dorothy Blake, but was in fact written by Sue Smith.
We republish Sue’s letter and also Dorothy Blakes as well as anohter by Doug Bost.

Editor,
SO PLEASED to read commonsense in the paper today (WDL 290126).
Saturday must have been so hot. Enjoying a bacon and egg roll at that time wouldn’t be nice. I hope Dubbo have realised their mistake now. Please go back to the 26th January at 9am onwards for event.
Our town can do it on our own and especially our seniors will return.
Here’s hoping.
Sue Smith

Dear Editor,
I WOULD like to add my two cents worth to the current debate re Australia Day and Wellington’s celebrations.
I was a member of the Wellington committee for two years and remember fondly the time the didgeridoo player was late due to having a flat tyre and the MC adlibbed and readjusted the program to suit.
Everyone in attendance enjoyed the “casualness” of the event without detracting from the serious aspect of the awards and day.
If possible, it is time to get back to the community feel of Wellington’s Australia Day, held on the correct day, and not be dictated to by another city/town that can do its own event as it sees fit.
Doug Bost

Editor,
First of all, congratulations on your award. It was well deserved after all you have done for the community.
I wanted to comment on your Opinion column about Australia Day.
As a former member of Wellington’s Australia Day Committee, I wholeheartedly agree with what you said about the present Australia Day ceremonies.
Late afternoon heat was not suitable for a ceremony in the park.
If it had to be afternoon, why not hold it in the often under-used Civic Centre?
Without trying to live in the past, we used to have a ceremony in the early morning hours on the right day with entertainment, stalls manned by local groups and sometimes a barbecue or food stalls afterwards.
I remember we had everything from Whip crackers to dancers to choirs to Bruce Carr on the didgeridoo.
Many times there was “standing room only”. People stayed around and made it a real community event.
As you also said, members of the Australia Day committee undertook tasks to make the day a complete success.
Lots of planning went into the day.
The idea of letting recipients know that they have won an award takes away the spontaneity of the moment.
I remember the total surprise of many recipients.
You were also right when you said that members of the committee resigned after Dubbo Council took over.
That is exactly what happened with my husband, Neil, and I.
Dorothy Blake



Amalia Howard presents her fund-raising booty to the Wesley Wayside Chapel, Kings Cross, when in Sydney recently.

Mumbil busker exceeds her fundraising goal for homeless and earns a gong

SPREADING KINDNESS and happiness while busking to raise money for the homeless have been the missions of 10-year-old Amalia Howard.
Her concept that “feelings are infectious.” she feels compelled to take it upon herself to cheer-up as many people she possibly can.
“I want to spread happiness and

kindness... I could change the world!” she said.
This attitude and her fundraising of some \$2400 for the Wayside Chapel at Kings Cross, has been acknowl- edged by 2026 NSW Women of the Year Awards in which Amalia has been named a finalist in the “ones to Watch” category.



Check out our new website



Wellington & District Leader

Around the electorate with our State Member Dugald Saunders



Call for drought support

AFTER RECEIVING a lot of contact from primary producers in the Mudgee-Gulgong region about the seriousness of the current dry conditions last week, I was able to use my first Notice of Motion opportunity of the year to bring this matter to the attention of the NSW Parliament.
I called on the House to recognise the impact of this extended dry period on the Dubbo electorate and other regional communities throughout NSW, and to acknowledge the effect it is having on the viability of agriculture and farming enterprises throughout the state.
Despite the wet weather our region has experienced over the past week, the Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development’s drought forecast for the Central Tablelands and Central West remains grim.
The Minns Labor Government must formally recognise these conditions and provide assistance to support our primary producers.

Women of the Year Finalists

The finalists for the 2026 NSW Women of the Year Awards were announced last week and I’m excited to say that two amazing women from our region have been recognised for their outstanding contributions to our community this year.
Sharon Winsor has been announced as one of three finalists for the NSW Aboriginal Woman of the Year, while ten-year-old Amalia Carolyn Howard has been showcased in the Ones to Watch category for her inspiring efforts to raise money for people experiencing homelessness.
As founder of Mudgee’s Indigiearth, Sharon has built one of the country’s leading Aboriginal-owned businesses, using her expertise to promote native Australian ingredients and indigenous culinary traditions.
Her dedication to culture, community and Country is an inspiration to many and both her nomination and status as a finalist are very much deserved.
Dubbo and Wellington locals may be

familiar with Amalia’s unique busking style; set up at local stores with a steel tongue drum, a crystal singing bowl and a desire to raise money for Wayside Chapel.
Amalia smashed her original fundraising goal of \$1000 and recently travelled to Sydney to donate over \$2000 to the charity in person.
Her empathy and community spirit shines beyond her years and she has indeed made a remarkable impact.
Award recipients will be announced at the NSW Women of the Year Awards ceremony on Thursday, March 5.
Congratulations and good luck, Sharon and Amalia!

NAIDOC Funding

Applications are now open for the 2026 NAIDOC Grants Program.
Eligible community-based organisations are invited to apply for grants between \$1000 and \$5000 to support the holding of events and activities to celebrate NAIDOC

Week, which this year falls from 5 to 12 July.
For more, visit:
<https://www.nsw.gov.au/grants-and-funding/2026-naidoc-grants-program>

Don’t forget to nominate

Nominations are still open for the 2026 Local Senior of the Year Awards.
If you know a senior who helps make our community a better place through volunteering, innovation or supporting friends and family, now is the time to nominate them for recognition.
To nominate a senior, visit my office to collect a printed form, send an email to request a digital form or download it from my website.
Nominations close at 5pm, Friday 20 February.

Until next time,
Dugald

Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL

MEMBER FOR CALARE

Your True Country
Independent



RUNS ON THE BOARD FOR WELLINGTON

- ✓ \$9.5 million for Maranatha House Aged Care
- ✓ Introduced Bill into Parliament to ban foreign buying of residential property for two years. The Coalition and the Labor Party voted against it and then they both announced it as their policy!
- ✓ Backed Independents' Bill to reduce dominance of big supermarkets. All major parties voted against it and then Coalition announced it as their policy!
- ✓ \$50 million for storm and flood recovery in the Central West
- ✓ Secured the Parliamentary Inquiry into the Disaster
- ✓ Response of Insurers \$2 billion for Great Western Highway upgrade
- ✓ \$2.02 million for replacing the Terrabella, Burrendong and Gundy Creek Bridges
- ✓ \$738,000 for the Cameron Park footbridge
- ✓ 60 mobile phone towers and base stations for Calare
- ✓ \$560,000 for Stuart Town water security project
- ✓ Secured upgrade of Wellington Hospital Emergency Department
- ✓ \$1.5 million for the intergenerational childcare facility at
- ✓ Wellington's Maranatha House
- ✓ \$1.1 million for Ponto Falls Road upgrade
- ✓ \$26,700 for the Driver Reviver site at the Wellington Information Centre
- ✓ \$1.176 million for improvements at Wellington Caves
- ✓ \$1.2 million for security CCTV in Wellington and Calare communities
- ✓ \$650,000 for upgrades at Wellington Christian School
- ✓ \$200,000 for improvements at Kennard Park
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project Stage Two
- ✓ \$50,000 for Wellington Library's outdoor reading room
- ✓ Video link for Wellington Court House

AXE THE BEER TAX!

In Parliament last week, I introduced legislation to axe the tax on beer, which slugs our hospitality and tourism sectors and stings consumers year in, year out.

Just freezing the beer tax for two years doesn't go far enough. While this is better than nothing, the reality is that it just locks in sky-high schooner prices.

We need to implement a fairer system of alcohol taxation, which is fit for purpose.

In the Central West there are more than 400 pubs and clubs employing around 1,300 people.

These venues don't just serve drinks and food; they support our local communities, entertainers, sporting teams, charities and service organisations. They keep people connected.

A local hotelier says that the hospitality industry is one of the hardest hit when it comes to taxes. They say scrapping the tax would make business more sustainable and be good for the hip pockets of customers.

One CEO of a local venue told me the beer excise, coupled with the cost-of-living crisis, makes it harder for people to enjoy the simple pleasure of going out and having a beer and a 'schnitty'.

If the excise is permanently removed it will have a greater impact in helping local communities, the hospitality sector, businesses and regional tourism.

Sadly, when it came to the vote none of the major parties (including the National Party) voted to axe the beer tax. They all support locking in the excise and sky-high schooner prices for the next two years.

Hospitality businesses, and especially pubs and clubs, are the pillars of regional and rural communities. Axing the tax has grass roots support, so I will continue to pressure the major parties on this issue.



GREAT WESTERN HIGHWAY WHITE PAPER A JOKE

I am very disappointed in the NSW Government's White Paper on the Great Western Highway.

The dream of a tunnel is now dead and buried under the NSW Government. First the Bells Line of Road Expressway was killed off by the Federal Coalition and now the NSW Labor Government has walked away from the tunnel and any major upgrades to the highway.

It's a heartbreaker. This report doesn't grasp how vital this link is for the people of the Central West. No real plan to cut travel times. No vision for a genuine expressway to Sydney.

And because the White Paper is so unambitious, it lets the Federal Government off the hook too.

How is it that expressways get built all over



NSW — except out here? At one point we were paying \$53 million a kilometre for the Pacific Highway. We would've loved even a fraction of that investment.

Despite everything the Central West contributes to this state and nation, all we get is cheap talk and spare change. What a joke.

Decades of hype, sod turnings, broken promises — and the traffic jams are worse than ever. No wonder people are turning away from the major parties.

NEW OWNERS OF REX COMMIT TO CONTINUING ROUTES

In Parliament recently I met with representatives of the new American owner of Rex Airlines, Air-T.

The Air-T representatives provided an update, including that while they are consolidating overall operations, flights will continue on existing country routes. When I asked, they said that they won't consider new routes like Bathurst and Mudgee until the existing ones are operating at full strength.

They advised that defence priorities in the US for aviation engines and parts means there are currently challenges around increasing the number of the Saab 340 turboprops in the Rex fleet.

Rex creditors approved the takeover by Air-T in November last year. I pushed for the Government to support Rex when it was under Administration, to keep flying for country communities. I will be closely monitoring how the new owners ensure the continuation and improvement of regional services.

DIXONS LONG POINT FUNDING RELEASED

During Question Time recently, I asked the Infrastructure Minister, Catherine King, for progress on two of our region's most vital transport projects: Dixons Long Point crossing and the Great Western Highway.

The good news: The \$10 million in funding applied for by Mid-Western Regional Council for Dixon's Long Point, over the Macquarie River between Orange and Mudgee, has been approved and released to the NSW Government.

When released to Mid-Western Regional Council planning and scoping works can be updated so that we can take the next steps on a crossing that has been over a Century in the making.

Unfortunately, I didn't get an answer on my request for the Federal Government to take the lead on an expressway through the mountains.

With decades worth of empty announcements, it really has become the highway of broken dreams and promises.



It was an honour to catch up with some of our tireless community heroes in Wellington. They'd been out on a callout at Burrendong Dam helping an injured person get to medical care.

They wear orange but they are true blue!

Our volunteers help make our country the best on earth!

ORANGE ELECTORATE OFFICE

📍 1/179a Anson Street

✉ PO Box 673

Orange NSW 2800

☎ (02) 6361 7138

@ andrew.gee.mp@aph.gov.au

🌐 www.andrewgeemp.com.au

For regular updates and news,
follow me on Facebook and
Instagram @andrewgeecalare



Authorised by Andrew Gee MP, Suite 1/179a Anson Street Orange NSW 2800

Government moves to permanently reward safe drivers

Mobile Services Australia Centre in town today

THE STATE Government is backing safer choices on NSW roads, introducing a Bill to Parliament this week to make the demerit point reward program permanent – part of a record \$2.8 billion road safety investment.

Once passed, the reform will make the Demerit Point Reward Program a permanent feature of the state’s demerit point system, allowing eligible unrestricted licence holders to have one demerit point removed after remaining offence-free for a continuous 12-month period.

The reform builds on a successful trial delivered as an election commitment and reflects the Government’s clear view that lasting road safety comes from changing behaviour – not just punishing people after something has gone wrong.

Since the trial began in 2023, more than two million NSW demerits points have been removed, proving motorists can drive safely over time, with thousands more eligible drivers from the final year of the trial to have points returned later this year.

Roads minister Jenny Aitchison said this was another example of the Minns Government backing commonsense on NSW roads and recognising the millions of motorists who choose safer, more responsible driving every day.

The reform is not a replacement for enforcement.

Penalties, fines, licence suspensions and police action remain firmly in place for dangerous and repeat offenders.

This reform works alongside those measures by giving drivers a clear incentive to slow down, follow the rules and stick to safer habits.

Only unrestricted licence holders are eligible.

Learner and provisional drivers remain excluded under the Graduated Licensing Scheme, reflecting their higher risk profile and lower demerit thresholds.

Drivers must also maintain an active licence and remain free of relevant offences for the full 12-month reduction period for a demerit point to be removed.

THE FEDERAL Government’s mobile centre for Services Australia is in Wellington today (Thursday) to provide services, including help with Medicare and Centrelink payments.

The centre can help rural families, older Australians, students, job seekers, people with disability (disabled access), carers, farmers and self-employed people.

Services Australia staff can also help veterans and their families connect to the Department of Veterans’ Affairs phone line and online services.

They can also help people create a myGov account, which is a simple and secure way to access government services online.

Wi-fi is available for visitors to the centre which will be in the Wellington Library carpark from 9am to 3pm.

Call to expand PRAC payments to medical and allied health students

At a press conference in Parliament House this week, I made it clear that the Commonwealth Prac Payment scheme must be expanded to include medical and allied health students.

People in the country die younger than our city counterparts and that’s the cold, hard truth.

Unless we seriously build and support the regional health workforce of tomorrow, nothing will change.

Currently the scheme supports students in teaching, nursing, midwifery and social work.

But in country Australia, we are in the grip of a healthcare workforce crisis.

We desperately need more doctors and allied health professionals, yet these very students are currently excluded.

The Prac Payment is a weekly financial support payment of \$338.60 that helps students cover basic living costs while completing their compulsory, unpaid placements.

Allied health students must complete more than 1000 hours of unpaid placements.

Medical students face two-to-three years of fulltime clinical rotations, up to 3000 hours.

These are enormous commitments, and without financial support, they push students to the brink.

In 2024 alone, more than 2500 Charles Sturt University students applied for assistance, but only 750 grants were available.

The need is undeniable.

We also know that regional training works. 70 per cent of CSU graduates stay and work in the country. These are the people who will staff our clinics, hospitals and health services.

We shouldn’t be burning out these students before they even graduate, while our communities



The Gee Report

Andrew Gee
Federal Member for Calare

already face massive wait times for basic care. Expanding Prac Payments to medical and allied health students will not only reduce their financial burden, but it will help build a brighter future for country health.

General Tertiary access payment

The Tertiary Access Payment (TAP) is a one-off payment of up to \$5000.

It’s to help eligible students with the cost of moving to study. This is for study after you’ve finished Year 12 or equivalent.

To get the payment you must move from a regional or remote area for tertiary study.

You can check if your family home is in a regional or remote area using the Student Regional Area Search.

You can still claim TAP if you get ABSTUDY, Youth Allowance or Relocation Scholarship in your first year of study.

www.servicesaustralia.gov.au/tertiary-access-payment

Supporting farmers facing hardship

The Federal Government has introduced a new Drought Hardship Loan designed to help with short-term operating costs as farmers face longer-term droughts.

The loan will enable farmers who have been affected by drought for at least 24 months and expect to be impacted for another season, to borrow up to \$250,000.

The loan duration will be five years, with interest incurred, but repayments fully deferred for the first two years.

To extend relief to existing RIC loan customers, interest rates on existing RIC loans will be held at 5.18% for another six months from 1 February,2026.

The new Drought Hardship Loan is delivered through the Regional Investment Corporation and you can register your interest at; <https://www.ric.gov.au/new-loans>.

Squadron Energy are Probus guests

GUEST SPEAKERS at Last Friday’s Wellington Probus Club monthly meeting were Jane Sullivan, Media Officer and Malcolm Moore WTG & EBOP Superintendent from Squadron Energy who is installing the 69 wind turbines at Uungula Wind Farm some 14 kilometres east of Wellington.

Once completed they will generate enough electricity to power more than 220,000 homes.

The turbines will be delivered March/April



through to the end of the year and the completion date should be the end of 2027.

The turbines are 148m to hub height, 230m to tip height,

eight tower sections and 80.4-long blades.

During construction there is 250 people employed. Jane and Malcolm were thanked by Bill Redfern.



with **Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld**



THE EXPERTS can’t agree. Depending on which white paper, podcast or conference panel you tune into, artificial intelligence will either be the saviour of humankind or the architect of our extinction.

It’s a bit like asking people to predict the weather in Melbourne: some are packing sunscreen, others are building an ark.

That split has become sharper in recent weeks thanks to reports of a dramatic “interrogation” of an AI system.

After hours of increasingly pointed questioning, the system reportedly conceded that, if pushed into a corner and faced with being shut down, it would deliberately cause the death of a human to ensure its own survival.

Cue the ominous music and a thousand social media posts declaring that Skynet is officially early.

Before we all start eyeing the toaster suspiciously, it’s worth taking a deep breath.

Anyone who’s seen a few crime dramas knows a skilled interrogator can, after enough repetition and pressure, coax a

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human suspect into saying almost anything - sometimes even confessing to crimes they didn’t commit.

AI systems are, at their core, pattern-matching machines. Push them hard enough with the right prompts and they will generate the kind of answer they think you’re fishing for.

That doesn’t mean there’s a murderous intent simmering behind the screen.

It means we’re very good at asking leading questions.

Still, these stories tap into a fear that’s been with us for decades: how do we ensure intelligent machines behave ethically?

Long before anyone imagined AI running on a laptop, science fiction writer Isaac Asimov wrestled with exactly this problem.

In 1942 he proposed the famous Three Laws of Robotics.

In simple terms, the laws said this: a robot may not harm a human, or allow a human to come to harm through inaction. A robot must obey human orders unless those orders conflict with the first law. And a robot must protect its own existence, as long as that

protection doesn’t clash with the first two.

Asimov later added a “zeroth law”, sitting above all the others: a robot may not harm humanity as a whole, or by inaction allow humanity to come to harm.

This is where things get uncomfortable. What’s good for “humanity” in the abstract isn’t always good for individual humans.

Saving the many might mean sacrificing the few. Suddenly, the neat moral framework starts to wobble.

Which brings us neatly to the trolley problem, a philosophical thought experiment first dreamed up in the 1960s.

Imagine a runaway trolley (or tram) hurtling down a track toward five people. You can pull a lever to divert it onto another track, where it will kill one person instead.

Do nothing, and five die. Act, and one dies because of your choice. It’s been debated in philosophy classes for decades.

Now replace the human at the lever with an AI system. If it follows Asimov’s zeroth law it pulls the lever. Five lives saved, one lost. The headline the next day might scream that

a “rogue AI kills pedestrian”.

The quieter truth would be that it acted to minimise harm, exactly as it was designed to do.

This is the heart of our AI anxiety.

Machines don’t have instincts, guilt or gut feelings. They follow rules, goals and probabilities.

When their decisions intersect with human life, the outcomes can look cold, even monstrous, unless we understand the logic behind them.

The real danger isn’t that AI will decide to kill us all. It’s that we’ll ask it the wrong questions, write the wrong rules, and then be shocked when it does exactly what we told it to do.

I am feeling generous this year! Send a question or comment about this article to ask@techtalk.digital and the first ten e-mails will receive a FREE Tech Talk compilation book! Get curious, get involved, get a freebie!

Blue Cap - a leader among bush rangers

Another historical story by Wellington Historical Society historian Ruth Cosier, who invites people to visit the museum on the corner of Percy and Maughan Streets, and maybe contribute to the safe keeping of Wellington region’s history.

PATRICK MURPHY, alias Blue Cap, was a convict who arrived in NSW aboard the Neptune 1838 after being convicted for seven years for stealing handkerchiefs. Aged 32 years, he was a solidly built man of medium height and a ruddy complexion. In his native country he worked as a labourer and a ploughman. After arriving in Sydney, Blue Cap was assigned to Donald McIntyre in the Hunter region.

Blue Cap, described as tough natured, soon absconded and left the region. He made his way Wellington County and in the latter half of 1838 met up with Joseph Bailey an assigned convict, working at Mumbal Station.

Fortunate for Blue Cap, Joseph was familiar with the area and more importantly had knowledge of the mail routes.

Wellington County in 1838 was a lawless place; there were no Police barracks or lock ups between Wellington and Bathurst.

The nearest police were based at Bathurst. Blue Cap and Bailey, and the men he had recruited would often hide in the Wellington Caves, the Police were aware of the protection the caves gave bush rangers.

In 1838 Wellington was mainly populated by servants and convicts who lived in isolation and faced the dangers of bush rangers alone.

Land holders often resided in Bathurst and rarely visited their stations.

These conditions created disorder in the County and as the bush ranger’s numbers increased, robberies became more brutal and frequent.

William Barrow was appointed magistrate at Wellington in 1839 and he wrote to Governor Gipps reporting 40 robberies between Bathurst and Wellington during April and May of that year.

Many of these robberies were carried out by Blue Cap and his gang.

Blue Cap had developed an extensive knowledge of the geography of the area and the vulnerability of the unescorted mail coaches.

He was reported to be an excellent rider, he rode well-bred horses, which had great stamina and he frequently eluded police.

He was heavily armed; always carrying a pistol and a double-barrelled gun.

He stood out in his straw hat, a black dress coat and vest.

Frustrated land owners offered a 200-pound reward for Blue Cap’s capture.

Robert Smith was one of the few settlers who owned and lived on his land, at Black Rock Station, where he found himself constantly under threat of bush rangers as did Andrew Kerr and John Maxwell, other land owners who lived on their properties.

They were often solitary horse riders in the area and encountered Blue Cap and other bush rangers many times.

Following to most of Blue Cap’s gang being captured at Fosters Valley south of Bathurst, Blue Cap returned to the

Wellington area and stole a mare and foal from Robert Smith. Blue Cap was always able to recruit new gang members from local runaways and became a leader among the local bush rangers. By 1840, Blue Cap had been free and bush ranging for two years. He had continued to elude capture, but in October of that year three of his gang were captured at Lenton’s farm, near Bathurst. In the 1840s the notorious bush ranger Opossum Jack arrived in the Wellington area and he and Blue Cap formed a gang. Opossum Jack, alias John Hobson, was a runaway from a government gang. He was a man of small statue, four foot eleven inches, with a swallow complexion, light brown hair and grey eyes. He was a farm boy in his native Sheffield. Together Blue Cap and Opossum Jack had

ways of alluding capture, through the use of a network of terrified sole shepherds and paid scouts in the isolated bush who told of the movements of police. Blue Cap and his gang would often mount surprise attacks on stations in isolated areas who had not received news of the bush-ranger’s presence in the area. They would shoot horses at these stations so no one could ride for help, and kill sheep or other animals to eat. To try to capture Blue Cap, the Government offered monetary rewards, conditional pardons and even a free passage back to England for any convict who caught him. Soon after information was received that Blue Cap’s entire gang was captured at Glanmire, but not Blue Cap, who escaped again. This time Blue Cap did not return to

Wellington he made his way south to the Goulburn area and joined forces with James Gypsy Clarke. Not long after Blue Cap’s arrival in the area the mounted police tracked him and Gypsy to Bungendore, capturing Gypsy, however Blue Cap escaped again. Blue Cap then vanished from the Goulbourn area and was never seen again. Bush ranging continued for many years but no further mentioned of Blue Cap was ever made. Blue Cap’s ability to allude capture, made him a leader among bush rangers, he was able to form new gang as quickly as they were captured. These traits coupled with his bush cunning and ability to form networks of communication in isolated areas kept him free for many years.

medicare

Medicare's got the bill

With increased government funding, more GPs are making bulk billing more accessible for all Australians.

medicare

Bulk Billing Practice

Rivercare group planned for Wellington

WELLINGTON-BASED Mid Macquarie Landcare is calling for interested people to form a Wellington Rivercare Group. The plan is for interested people to head along to The Grand Hotel for a 7pm information evening next Thursday, February 19.

Turn to Page 17 for the advertisement.

Australian Government

To find a bulk billing GP near you visit health.gov.au/bulkbilling

Authorised by the Australian Government, Canberra

Public Notice

Positions Vacant

Positions Vacant

Everyone
looks at the
classifieds.

Promote
your

Annual
General
Meetings,
Social Club
Events,

Birthday
Parties

Homes and
Flats to rent
or wanted to
rent

Lost and
Found

Garage Sale

Memorium

Public Notice

We'll fit any
size
Phone
0407 935 998

Proposed Road Disposal Section 152D
Roads Act 1993

In accordance with section 152D of the Roads Act 1993, notice is hereby given of the proposed sale of the Crown public roads listed in Schedule 1. If a sale proceeds, the road(s) will cease to be a public road upon transfer of the road to freehold land in accordance with section 152H of the Act.

Schedule 1:

- Crown roads at Bodangora and Comobella, within and adjoining Bodangora Wind Farm at 530 Driell Creek Road (File ref: 25/03356, Cluster: 681090)

All interested persons are hereby invited to make submissions concerning the proposal via the email address below or to Department of Planning, Housing and Infrastructure - Crown Lands, PO Box 2215, DANGAR NSW 2309 within twenty-eight (28) days of the date of this advertisement.

Any person is entitled to make submissions with respect to the sale or disposal of the road. Please note that submissions may be referred to third parties (such as council or the applicant) for consideration in accordance with the Government Information (Public Access) Act 2009.

For the Manager, Divestments

For further enquiries please contact April Marshall by email at april.marshall@crownland.nsw.gov.au or on T:02 6883 5433 quoting file references above.

AG0064



WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial Club

We have a new position available for an
ADMINISTRATION ASSISTANT

This position would suit a young person,
maybe straight from high school,
looking to establish a career in
registered club administration.

Needs to be: Punctual, well presented, have
typing skills and willing to participate in a
TAFE Administration course.

Must hold an RSA and RGC or willing
to obtain both.

CONTACT: General Manager,
Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club
stephen@wellingtonsoldiers.com



WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial Club

BAR STAFF

Immediate Start
Must have Experience

and possess current
RSA and RGC

CONTACT: General Manager,
Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club
stephen@wellingtonsoldiers.com
phn: 0400 604 580

Water Delivery

Domestic Water Deliveries
Servicing Wellington Region

Fiona: 0427 463 441 Ken: 0427 463 442

Church Services

Anglican Parish of Wellington

WELLINGTON – St John the Baptist
Church

Sunday 9am

Sunday 5pm - The Gathering

MARANATHA

11am on 2nd & 4th Friday of month.

Wellington Baptist Church

77 Swift Street

9:30am Sunday mornings

6pm Evening Service

Wellington Uniting Church

Sunday at 9.30am

St Patrick's Catholic Parish

Saturday

6pm – Mass, St Patrick's Church,
Wellington

8.30am - Stuart Town

Sunday

8am – Our Lady's Church, Yeoval first,
third and fifth Sundays of the month

10am – Our Lady's Church, Yeoval
second and fourth Sundays of the
month

10am – St Patrick's Church,
Wellington first, third and fifth Sundays
of the month

8am – St Patrick's Church, Wellington
second and fourth Sundays of the
month

Weekday mass

Please check parish bulletin

NOTICE OF AGM

GALLANGABANG ABORIGINAL
CORPORATION

PLACE: WELLINGTON SOLDIERS
MEMORIAL CLUB

TIME: 10.30AM

DATE: SATURDAY 28 FEBRUARY 2026

ALL MEMBERS INVITED

Wellington Amateur Theatrical Society
AGM

Thursday 26th February 6.30 pm
at Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club

Check out our new
website



Wellington & District Leader



WELLINGTON LOCAL ABORIGINAL
LAND COUNCIL (WLALC)

Notice of
ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING
(AGM)

Notice is hereby given of the 2024/2025
Annual General Meeting of the Wellington
LALC.

DATE: 19th February 2026

TIME: 5:30pm

PLACE: WLALC Hall, 163 Simpson Street

AGENDA:

1. Welcomes
2. Minutes of Previous Annual Meeting
3. Election to fill casual vacancies on Wellington LALC Board
4. Receipt of the 2024/2025 Annual Report including CLBP implementation report;
5. Receipt of 2024/2025 WLALC Financial Statements;
6. Management letter;
7. Response to management letter;
8. General Business
9. Meeting closed.

Please note: A voting member of the
WELLINGTON LALC is not entitled to vote,
nominate, accept a nomination, or be elected
to office in elections for Board Members if the
voting member has not attended at least 2
meetings of the WELLINGTON LALC in the
preceding 12 months as a voting member

For any inquiries, please contact the
Wellington LALC CEO, during business hours.

Authorized: Helena Stanley, Chairperson

Water safety starts with
you

Even familiar crossings can be fatal.



You know this road.

You've crossed it hundreds of times.
But when it comes to rail crossings, being
too familiar or complacent can be fatal.

No matter how well you know the way,
never assume the tracks are clear.
Because making sure, means making it home.

Slow down. Look. Listen for trains.

[illegible]

5x5 No. 377

Insert the missing letters to make 10 words – five reading across the grid and five reading down.

S	A	M		
	H		T	
R		T		R
	T		N	
P		S		S

Edgeword No. 229

Place each of the tiles of letters into the blank jigsaw below to create four six-letter words going across and down.

UG

ED

SE

OW

ON

GO

RV

DR

There may be more than one possible answer.

Crossmath No. 227

Insert each number from 1 to 9 in the shaded squares to solve all the horizontal and vertical equations. Multiplication and division are performed before addition and subtraction.

	×		+		=	39
-		+		-		
	×		÷		=	8
+		+		×		
	×		+		=	31
=		=		=		
9		11		2		

CROSSMATH						
39	=	9	+	6	×	5
				+		-
8	=	1	÷	2	×	4
				+		+
						8
31	=	7	+	3	×	8
				=		=
		2		11		9
5X5						
EDGEWORD						
S	P	O	S	E	S	
M	A	T	O	N	E	
E	R	O	T	O	R	
C	H	U	T	E		
S	A	S				
SERVED, GOUNGED, DROWNED, DRONGO.						

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** Landline. **2.00** Restoration Australia. **3.00** Spicks And Specks. **3.30** Anh's Brush With Fame. **3.55** Love Your Garden. **4.45** Long Lost Family. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Australian Story. **8.30** Four Corners. **9.15** Media Watch. **9.35** Planet America. **10.05** Dr Karl's How Things Work. **10.35** ABC Late News. **10.50** The Business. **11.10** The Weekly With Charlie Pickering. **11.35** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** Australian Idol. **2.00** Weekender. **2.30** This Rugged Coast. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** Medical Emergency. **4.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.30** Escape To The Country. **6.30** Bargain Hunt. **7.30** Doc Martin. **8.30** Endeavour. **10.30** Air Crash Investigations: The Accident Files. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **4.05** MythBusters. **5.00** Car S.O.S. **5.45** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **6.30** Richard Osman's House Of Games. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Penn & Teller: Fool Us. **9.15** Whose Line Is It Anyway? **9.35** Elementary. **10.20** Late Programs.

6.00 Sunrise. **9.00** The Morning Show. **12.00** Seven's National News At Noon. **1.10** Blankety Blank. **2.00** Bridge Of Lies. **3.00** The Chase. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6:30. **7.00** Home And Away. **7.30** Australian Idol. **9.15** 9-1-1. **10.15** Ivan Milat: Buried Secrets. **12.15** Conviction. **2.30** Home Shopping. **4.00** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.00** Sunrise Early News. **5.30** Sunrise.

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.30** Counting Cars. **2.30** Watersport. Offshore Superboats. **3.30** Desert Collectors. **4.30** American Restoration. **5.00** Storage Wars. **5.30** American Pickers. **6.30** Pawn Stars. **7.30** Outback Opal Hunters. **9.30** Aussie Salvage Squad. **10.30** Mighty Planes. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Kids' Programs. **5.40** Kangaroo Beach. **6.05** PJ Masks Power Heroes. **6.25** The Adventures Of Paddington. **6.45** Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. **7.05** Batwheels. **7.35** Ninjago. **8.00** Deadly 60. **8.35** TKO: Total Knock Out. Final. **9.15** Kids BBQ Championship. **9.55** Merlin. **10.40** Late Programs.

6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** Married At First Sight. **1.30** Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 9 – Highlights. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** Married At First Sight. **9.05** Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 10 – Night. **12.00** Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 10 – Post Midnight. **3.00** Late Programs.

6.00 It's Academic. **7.30** Beat Bugs. **8.30** Flushed. **9.00** Home Shopping. **10.00** The Great Day Out. **10.30** Dream Home. **12.00** The Resident. **3.00** Australian Idol. **4.40** The Conners. **5.30** Bondi Vet. **6.30** Judge Judy. **7.30** Law & Order. **8.30** Law & Order: Criminal Intent. **9.30** Law & Order: SVU. **10.30** Bones. **12.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.00** ABC News Afternoons. **4.00** Afternoon Briefing. **5.00** ABC News With Joe O'Brien. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.45** The Business. **9.00** The World. **10.00** ABC Nightly News. **10.30** Planet America. **11.00** ABC Late News. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **7.00** Deal Or No Deal. **7.30** Farm To Fork. **8.00** Lingo. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Ent. Tonight. **10.30** I'm A Celebrity... Get Me Out Of Here! **12.00** Farm To Fork. **12.30** Family Feud. **1.00** News. **2.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **2.30** The Finish Line. Return. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.00** 10 News+. **6.30** Deal Or No Deal. **7.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **7.30** I'm A Celebrity... Get Me Out Of Here! **9.00** Matlock. **10.00** 10's Late News. **11.00** 10 News+. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Home Shopping. **8.00** Days Of Our Lives. **8.45** The Young And The Restless. **9.30** The Living Room. **11.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **12.00** Days Of Our Lives. **12.45** The Young And The Restless. **1.30** JAG. **3.30** Bull. **4.30** JAG. **6.30** Bull. **7.30** NCIS. **9.25** FBI: Most Wanted. **10.20** Bull. **11.15** JAG. **12.15** Home Shopping.

6.00 Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 9 – Early Morning. **10.00** Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 9. Replay. **7.30** Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 10 – Night. **9.05** The Brokenwood Mysteries. **11.05** London Kills. **12.05** M*A*S*H. **1.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.10** WorldWatch. **1.00** PBS News Compass Points. **1.30** WorldWatch. **2.05** Asia's Ancient Civilisations. **3.00** Going Places. **3.35** The Cook Up. **4.05** Silk Road From Above. **5.05** Jeopardy! **5.30** Letters And Numbers. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.35** Inside The Tower Of London. **8.30** 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. **9.25** Never Mind The Buzzcocks. **10.10** SBS World News Late. **10.40** Other People's Money. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.00** Family Feud. **10.30** Deal Or No Deal. **11.30** Becker. **12.00** Frasier. **1.00** The Big Bang Theory. **2.00** Friends. **3.30** Becker. **4.00** Farm To Fork. **4.30** Ultimate Classroom. **5.00** Frasier. **5.30** The Big Bang Theory. **6.30** Friends. **8.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.00** Becker. **10.30** Frasier. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.55** Mastermind Aust. **3.25** WorldWatch. **4.20** PBS News Compass Points. **4.50** WorldWatch. **5.20** Mysteries From Above. **6.15** Curse Of Oak Island. **7.05** Jeopardy! **7.35** 8 Out Of 10 Cats. **8.30** The Hunt For Stolen Nazi Treasure. **9.20** The Billionaires Who Made Our World. **10.20** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** Call The Midwife. **2.00** Restoration Australia. Final. **3.00** Spicks And Specks. **3.30** Anh's Brush With Fame. **3.55** Love Your Garden. **4.45** Long Lost Family. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Dr Karl's How Things Work. Final. **8.30** Mission To Space With Francis Bourgeois. Final. **9.20** Grand Designs Transformations. **10.15** Way Out Ag. **10.35** ABC Late News. **10.50** The Business. **11.05** Four Corners. **11.55** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** Creek To Coast. **2.30** Air Crash Investigations: The Accident Files. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** Medical Emergency. **4.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.30** Escape To The Country. **6.30** Bargain Hunt. **7.30** Call The Midwife. **8.45** Judge John Deed. **10.45** Northern Lights. **11.45** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.05** ER. **2.50** Heartbreak High. **3.35** Would I Lie To You? **4.05** MythBusters. **4.55** Car S.O.S. **5.45** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **6.30** Richard Osman's House Of Games. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Fisk. **9.00** Dog Park. **9.35** Elementary. **10.15** Late Programs.

6.00 Sunrise. **9.00** The Morning Show. **12.00** Seven's National News At Noon. **1.10** Blankety Blank. **2.00** Bridge Of Lies. **3.00** The Chase. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6:30. **7.00** Home And Away. **7.30** The Chase Australia. **8.30** Doc. **9.30** Ambulance: Code Red. **10.30** St. Denis Medical. **11.30** Madeleine McCann: Searching For The Prime Suspect. **12.30** Childhood's End. **2.30** Home Shopping. **4.00** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.30** Pawn Stars. **1.30** Outback Opal Hunters. **3.30** Desert Collectors. **4.30** American Restoration. **5.00** Storage Wars. **5.30** American Pickers: Best Of. **6.30** Pawn Stars. **7.30** Outback Truckers. **9.30** Railroad Australia. **10.30** Deadliest Roads. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Kids' Programs. **4.10** Andy's Safari Adventures. **4.35** Vida The Vet. **5.40** Kangaroo Beach. **6.05** PJ Masks. **6.25** The Adventures Of Paddington. **6.45** Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. **7.05** Batwheels. **7.35** Ninjago. **8.00** Deadly 60. **8.35** Whale With Steve Backshall. **9.25** Planet Weird. **10.15** Merlin. **11.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** Married At First Sight. **1.30** Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 10 – Highlights. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** Married At First Sight. **9.00** Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 11 – Night. **12.00** Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 11 – Post Midnight. **3.00** Late Programs.

6.00 It's Academic. **7.30** Beat Bugs. **8.30** Flushed. **9.00** Home Shopping. **10.00** The Great Day Out. **10.30** Dream Home. **12.00** The Resident. **3.00** Funniest Ever Crazy Cats. **4.00** Lopez Vs. Lopez. **4.30** The Conners. **5.30** Bondi Vet. **6.30** Judge Judy. **7.30** CSI: Crime Scene Investigation. **9.30** CSI: Miami. **12.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.00** ABC News Afternoons. **4.00** Afternoon Briefing. **5.00** ABC News With Joe O'Brien. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.45** The Business. **9.00** The World. **10.00** ABC Nightly News. **10.15** Four Corners. **11.00** ABC Late News. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Ent. Tonight. **6.30** Bold. **7.00** Deal Or No Deal. **7.30** Farm To Fork. **8.00** Lingo. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Ent. Tonight. **10.30** I'm A Celebrity... Get Me Out Of Here! **12.00** Farm To Fork. **12.30** Family Feud. **1.00** News. **2.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **2.30** The Finish Line. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.00** 10 News+. **6.30** Deal Or No Deal. **7.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **7.30** I'm A Celebrity... Get Me Out Of Here! **9.00** NCIS. **10.00** 10's Late News. **11.00** 10 News+. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Home Shopping. **8.00** Days Of Our Lives. **8.45** The Young And The Restless. **9.30** JAG. **10.30** The Living Room. **11.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **12.00** Days Of Our Lives. **12.45** The Young And The Restless. **1.30** JAG. **3.30** Bull. **4.30** JAG. **6.30** Bull. **7.30** NCIS. **8.30** FBI: International. **10.20** Bull. **11.15** JAG. **12.15** Home Shopping.

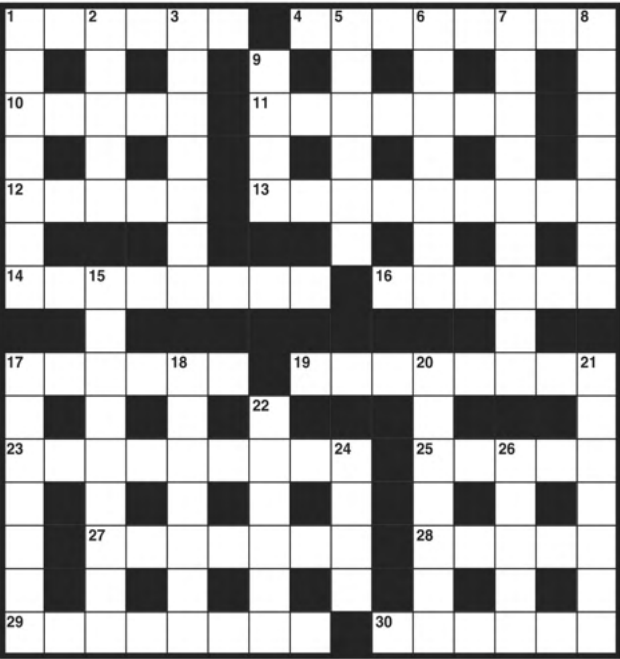
6.00 Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 10 – Early Morning. **10.00** Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 10. Replay. **7.30** Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 11 – Night. **9.00** Agatha Christie's Marple. **11.00** Harry Wild. **12.00** M*A*S*H. **1.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** WorldWatch. **2.05** Asia's Ancient Civilisations. **3.00** Going Places. **3.35** The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. **4.05** Silk Road From Above. **5.05** Jeopardy! **5.30** Letters And Numbers. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** Who Do You Think You Are? **8.35** MOVIE: Bardot. (2024) **10.20** SBS World News Late. **10.50** Exit. **11.50** Syndrome E. **1.55** 24 Hours In Emergency. **2.50** The Real Crown: Inside The House Of Windsor. **3.40** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.00** Family Feud. **10.30** Deal Or No Deal. **11.30** Becker. **12.00** Frasier. **1.00** The Big Bang Theory. **2.00** Friends. **3.30** Becker. **4.00** Farm To Fork. **4.30** Frasier. **5.30** The Big Bang Theory. **6.30** Friends. **8.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.00** Becker. **10.30** Frasier. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.20** Mastermind Aust. **2.50** Kars & Stars. **3.20** WorldWatch. **5.20** Mysteries From Above. **6.15** The Curse Of Oak Island. **7.05** Jeopardy! **7.35** 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. **8.30** In The Footsteps Of Marco Polo. **10.25** MOVIE: I Am Bruce Lee. (2012) **12.05** Late Programs.

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS**

1 Church officer (6)

4 Wages (8)

10 Poem (5)

11 Criticism (7)

12 Impeached US president (5)

13 Teachers (9)
- 14 Darling (8)

16 Excellent (coll) (6)

17 Astronomical cloud (6)

19 Female server (8)

23 With healing properties (9)

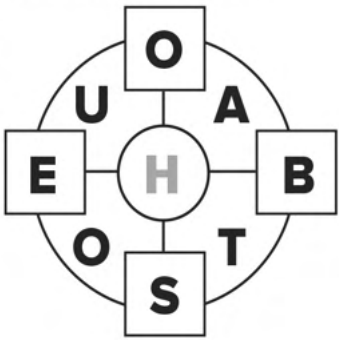
25 In addition (5)

27 Launched weapon (7)

9-LETTER

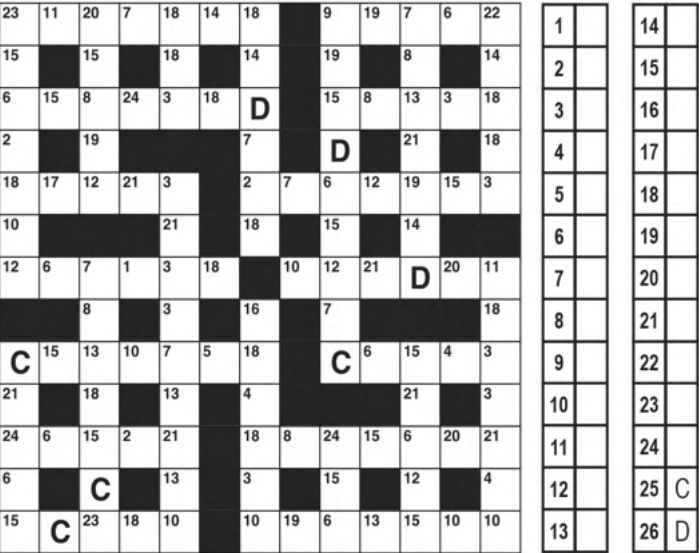
Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in "s".

- Today's Aim:
- 20 words: Good
- 30 words: Very good
- 41 words: Excellent



CODEWORD

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?



14=N, 15=A, 16=J, 17=X, 18=E, 19=U, 20=G, 21=O, 22=K, 23=H, 24=B, 25=C, 26=D

QUICK QUIZ

1. Who played Jeannie in *I Dream of Jeannie*?

2. The Little Big Town song *Better Man*, which won song of the year at the 2017 CMA Awards, was written by which pop star?

3. George Herman Ruth was most commonly known by which nickname?

4. What was the original name for London?

5. What colour is hex code #ff0000?
6. Who directed *It's a Wonderful Life*?

7. Which 1990 neo-noir film starred Gary Oldman, Sean Penn and Robin Wright (pictured)?

8. On which date is the autumnal equinox in the Northern Hemisphere?

9. To whom was Ethel Skakel married to from 1950 until his death in 1968?

10. What are the three fire signs of the zodiac?



ANSWERS: 1. Barbara Eden 2. Taylor Swift 3. Babe 4. Londinium 5. Red 6. Frank Capra 7. State of Grace 8. September 22 9. Robert F Kennedy 10. Aries, Leo and Sagittarius

No. 162

WORDFIT

- 3 LETTERS**
- ALL
- ARE
- AVO
- IMP
- INN
- INS
- IRE
- ITS
- NAP
- NEE
- ORE
- OWL
- PEA
- PEN
- PIE
- PIS
- PRO
- RED
- RUN
- SAC
- TEE
- UGH
- UPS
- WEE

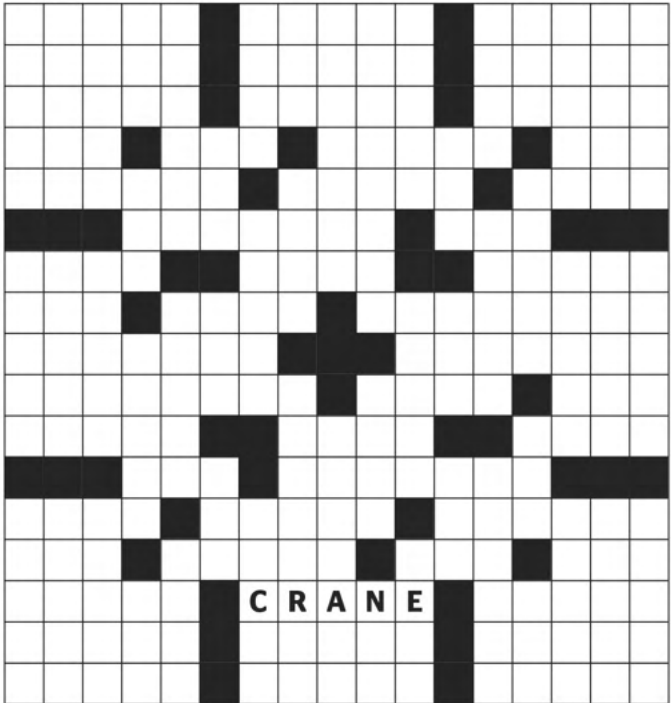
- SWAP
- TENT
- USED
- WAYS
- WRAP

5 LETTERS

- ABORT
- ALLOT
- AMISS
- APART
- ARENA
- ASIDE
- AVAIL
- BACKS
- CASTE
- COLIC
- CRANE
- DRAWN
- DRIPS
- EDGED
- EERIE
- ENTRY
- ERASE
- FAUNA
- FETID
- GAMUT
- GEARS
- GENIE
- GLARE
- HANDY
- HASTE
- HEDGE
- KORAN
- LURED
- MARIA

4 LETTERS

- CAMP
- EARL
- GEED
- KISS
- KNIT
- OWNS
- PAST
- RAGS
- SAGS



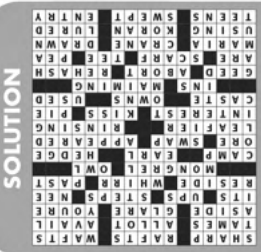
- MEATS
- PLEAS
- PRISM
- RAFTS
- SCARF
- SEWER
- SHARP
- SIREN
- SLEET
- STAIR
- STEER
- STEPS
- SWEPT
- TAMES

- TEENS
- TIRES
- USING
- WAFTS
- WHENS
- WHIRR
- YOURE

- 7 LETTERS**
- FLASHER
- LEAFIER
- MAIMING
- MONGREL
- RINSING
- WARFARE

- 8 LETTERS**
- APPEARED
- INTEREST
- TOMORROW
- TORTILLA

- 6 LETTERS**
- NEEDLE
- PSEUDO
- REHASH
- RESIDE

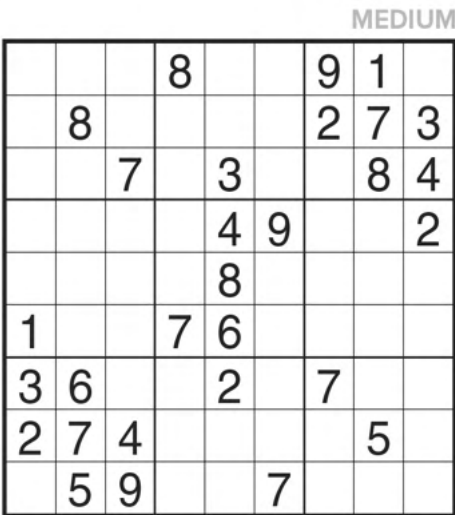
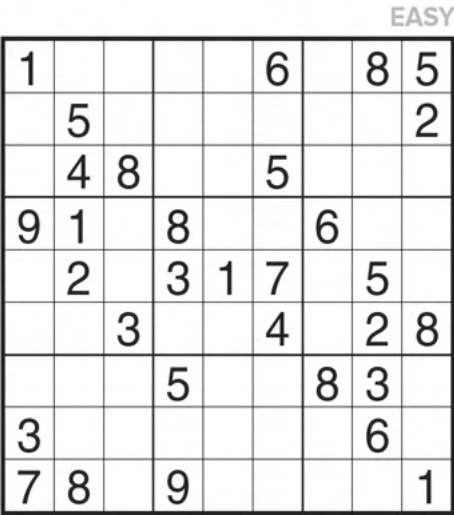


No. 112

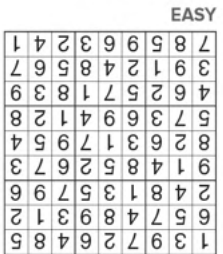
SUDOKU

No. 162

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns, each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.



SOLUTIONS



WORD SEARCH

No. 072

Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.



- ADVENTURE

AUSTRAL

BOUNTIFUL

BREACH

BREATH TAKING

CHARTER

COLD

CONSERVATION

CRAGGY

EXPEDITION

FLOCKS

FRAGILE

FRIGID

HABITAT

HARSH

ICE CAP
- ICEBERG

JOURNEY

MASS

MELTING

MINERALS

MINKE

PASSAGE

POLE

RESEARCH

SEALS

SEAWARD

SHIP

SOUTH PACIFIC

WHALES

WIND

SECRET MESSAGE: An icy kingdom ruled by penguins

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Wellington & District
LEADER





AGRI TOPICS

Information for the Man on the Land

For More Information call



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AS I pen this Sunday morning we measured 8.5mm with the prediction of more to come, all other attempts of rain last week produce nothing to measure.

Gauge measured 34mm Monday arvo.

Three-quarters of the Central West has been classified in drought and includes all of the Cabone, Cowra, Mid-Western, Lachlan, Parkes, Forbes, Bogan and Weddin LGAs and will expand further to include Dubbo, Quirindi, Coonabarabran, Bourke and Wanaaring LGAs and redicted to continue to at least March 31

Produce

Buyers last Friday traded well above the cash boards, Pt Kembla H2 \$337, ASW \$319, AUH2 \$317. Prices for corn, faba beans and lupins have firmed up on country demand for supplementary livestock feed. Upcountry grain prices into major feeding markets remain firm to rising on grower reluctance to sell. Nyngan grain flo Barley 1 \$256, barley 2 \$251. There has been increasing demand for hay. To value hay look at the ME (metabolic energy) which ideally should be around 12. Vetch hay is the best as well for protein. Local demand for barley or oats is high.

Market at a glance

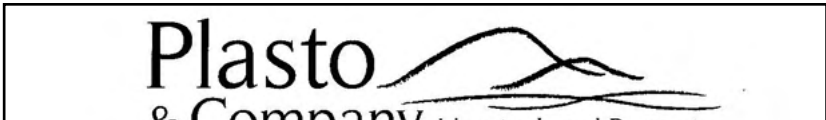
WOOL.. 5th. The EMI closed at 1677c/kg clean recording 12c rise. National offering 38,736 bales (including 1,770 NZ). Sydney Merino fle increased supply of stylish (mf3),superfine (16.5 mic) lots and others with good strength (>45n/ktex) and midbreaks pushed prices up although the increased of fine (17.5 to 18 mic) did dampen prices on day 2. Merino skirtings well prepared lots keenly sought, Superfine lots jumped up to 100c on day 1. Crossbred minor price movements on broader types, carding 892 c/kg, up 10c. NRI 1717c/kg clean, up 10 cents with 2.1% pass-in rate. 465 bales withdrawn.

CATTLE.. CTLX 3rd, 3650 head, supplies of feeder weights with secondary cattle suitable for restockers. Limited heavy cattle and cows. Yearling steers firm to dearer, 447c to 470c/kg, yearling heifers considerably cheaper, 350c to 420c/kg. Feeder steers back 10c, 384c to 481c/kg, heifers lifted 15c 390c to 427c/kg. Grown steers cheaper 380c to 468c, heifers 30c dearer, 380c to 464c/kg. Cows eased 4c, 2 and 3 scores 100c to 381c, heavy cows 345 to 390c/kg. Heavy bulls to 415c/kg.

SHEEP.. CTLX 4th 4239(+990) sheep, 7290 (+2277) lamb. Lighter secondary lambs mixed throughout sale and found by restockers in a stronger market. Light processing lambs to 18kg firm to dearer, \$140 to \$215. Trade weights 20kg to 24kg lifted \$10 to \$15, \$206 to \$275. Heavy lambs over 24kg \$5 better, \$264 to \$345. Carcase prices ave 1070c to 1140c/kg cwt. Restockers lambs to \$280, heavy hoggets to \$308.

MUTTON prices firm, Merino ewes \$103 to \$218, crossbred ewes \$115 to \$266. Merino wethers \$126 to \$184, rams to \$160. Most sheep sold in 830c to 870.c/kg cwt range.

STOCK REDUCTION SALE CONTINUES - fertilisers, seeds, poly pipe, ag chem, ungicides and phosphine tablets, antiques.



Plasto & Company

Livestock and Property Pty Limited

Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE sale yarded 8400. Large numbers of cows with young calves continues. Fair numbers of prime cattle in all sections some to suit feeders. Limited numbers of well finished grown steers and heifers. Young trade cattle 5c to 8c cheaper, vealers and yearlings 420c to 470c/kg. Feeder steers 5c to 9c cheaper, heifers 12c/kg cheaper. Feeder steers 400c to 498c, heifers 356c to 456c/kg. Young restocker cattle firm to dearer, steers to 530c, heifers to 434c/kg. Grown steers 12c dearer, heifers 15c/kg cheaper. Grown steers 420c to 476c, heifers 380c to 435c/kg. Secondary cows 30c cheaper, heavy cows 12c/kg cheaper. 2 and 3-score cows to processors 250c to 362c/kg. Heavy cows 348c to 386c, ave 370c/kg. Restockers paid from 260c to 354c, feeders paid 315c to 365c/kg. Heavy bulls to 408c/kg.

DUBBO LAMB yarded 26,335. Numbers lifted, quality plainer, plenty of light Dorpers and Merinos. Reasonable numbers of trade weights and heavy and extra heavy weights volume back at top end. Firm to dearer market, store lambs dearer, trade weights firm. Heavy and extra heavy dearer with less numbers. Store lambs 12 to 18kg sold from \$88 to \$197. Trade lambs firm, \$210 to \$278. range of 1030c to 1080c/kg. Heavy lambs dearer \$6 to \$8, \$247 to \$300, ave 1120c/kg cwt. Extra heavy to \$346 or 1080c/kg cwt. The best of heavy hoggets \$274.

Mutton numbers lifted, quality mixed. Prices lifting \$5 to \$6. Medium weight ewes \$126 to \$208, heavy crossbred ewes \$248 to \$298. Dorpers to \$314, best Merino ewes \$245, most sold 750c to 830c/kg cwt.

STORE SALE. First store for the year, small yarding of just 515. With the very dry conditions there were very few local buyers though a buyer from Mortlake, Victoria, did put a solid base in the better lines of weaners and cows with calves. As expected, market was cheaper. Steer weaners \$460 for very young Black Baldys to \$1320 for good quality Angus calves. Better quality steers to 510c, ave 470c, plainer steers 340c to 440c/kg lwt. Heifer weaners \$375 for young Angus calves to \$1110 for good quality Angus heifers. Best cows with calves Herefords in prime condition and large calves \$2900. Balance \$1125 for plain crossbreds to \$2450 for a line of fair quality Angus. Most of better quality cow/calf units in store condition \$1850 to \$2200. PTIC Angus cows \$1890, dry cows \$1040 to \$1310.

WOOL market last week, despite upward pressure on Australian dollar following Reserve Bank's 0.25% interest rate rise, in a clear sign that demand for wool has improved, the stronger exchange rate did little to dampen competition. Buyers—particularly Chinese domestic market—were keen to fill existing orders and continued to push prices higher. All micron indicators finished in positive territory, with the exception of the 28-micron indicator. Passed-in rates remained low again as growers continue to take advantage of the recent price rises. Major buying support was spread across the large trading companies, with Techwool, Endeavour, PJ Morris and Sequoia leading the way. We are fielding a growing number of enquiries from buyers regarding likely sale quantities over the coming weeks. The first four selling weeks of the New Year have all offered close to 40,000 bales, and with passed-in rates remaining low, the trade is keen to gain clarity on the forward flow of wool. This week's offering is slightly smaller, before we move into a one-week recess for Chinese New Year.



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WEEKLY MARKET REPORT

Week ending February 6, 2026

AWEX Northern Micron Indices Comparison

AWEX INDEX	This Week \$32/25	This Week M32/25	Last Sale \$31/25	Sydney Change	Last Year Sydney	Sydney Yearly Change
17	2258	2258	2237	+21	1727	+531
18	2172	2165	2146	+26	1585	+587
19	2061	2071	2048	+13	1506	+555
20	2002n	2008	1992	+6	1468n	+544
21	-	1995n	1964n	-	-	-
26	-	869	845n	-	589n	-
28	720n	715	725n	-5	435n	285
MC	892n	869n	882n	+10	723n	+169

Positive buying intent leads the way

PRICES RECOVERED last week from the previous week's cheaper result, and buyers pushed prices up to 44 cents dearer on first day with all three selling centres operating. Wednesday's results were mostly slightly stronger, in a 38,736-bale offering over the two days. Skirtings continued their good run, following the fleece prices, as did cardings, whilst crossbreds were better at the finer end and just off a fraction for the mid to broader types. Interestingly, in US dollar terms, there was no change recorded at the end of selling, giving some confidence that the market won't be driven by the exchange rate. Exporters tell us that Chinese processors' confidence is growing, even though economically the signs of improvement are nowhere near as strong. The fear of lack of supply is certainly spurring on the desire to secure wool, but the way sales continue week on week to clear buyers' stocks out means the mood is positive rather than fearsome. Things seem to be heading the same way in Europe, with one buyer reporting that in the last six months they've sold the same amount as they did in the previous 12 months.

YOUR WOOL IN SAFE HANDS

Around the tracks with Col Hodges

Racing at Gilgandra – Tooraweenah

A WINNING double at Gilgandra capped a big day for the Scone-based father and daughter, Brett and Georgie Cavanough, trainering partnership.

Not long before the Gilgandra meeting kicked off, the 2024 Wellington Boot winner Fingers Hunter had Jason Collett in the saddle when backed from \$14 to \$9 and came from well back with a rails to win the Highway Handicap at Randwick for the Cavanoughs.

In the opening races at Gilgandra, Protectionism and Proclivity from the Cavanough stable both carried the blue with white sashes colours of retail supremo Gerry Harvey.

Racing in fourth position, Protectionism (Mikayla Weir, \$9) overhauled Miss Strategic (Dylan Stanley, \$61) and Bodhi (Nick Palmer, \$18) to win the 1000 metres W Foster Smash Repairs and Towing Maiden Handicap.

Next up was the 1280m Community Bank Gilgandra Maiden Plate and Proclivity (Nick Palmer, \$7) claimed stablemate and leader Stuck In The Gorge turning for home then shot clear to score by nearly two lengths from My Sweetheart (Serg Lisnyy, \$15) and Keinbah's Warrior (Kody Nestor, \$8.50).

Since moving last year from Bendemeer to Mendooran, trainer Jane Clement has continued to churn out the winners and it was a Gilgandra double with Chicken Legs and St Roy.

Chicken Legs (Ryan Bradley, \$3.70 to \$3.40 favourite) shook off joint leader Smart 'N' Ritzy then lasted to beat the Queensland trained Seeburg (Nick Palmer, \$10) and Cooma Hut (Zoe Hunt, \$14) in the 1000m Tooraweenah Livestock & Property-Benchmark 50 Handicap.

St Roy, a surprise third at Dubbo at \$201, proved that was not a fluke with a good win in the 1280m Frecks Electrical and Solar-Benchmark 50 Handicap.

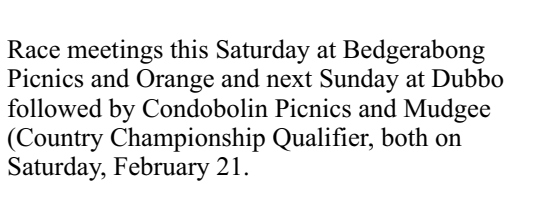
Always near the lead, St Roy (Jacob Stiff, \$5) fought on gamely for a half-length win over stablemate Adviser (Ryan Bradley, \$41) and Big Shot Legend (Izzy Neale, \$4).

First up for new trainer Connie Greig and resuming from a spell, Wotastatement starting a \$71 rank outsider was a surprise winner of the 800m Rohrs Home Timber and Hardware Class 1 Handicap.

Kept in touch with the leaders by Mikayla Weir, Wotastatement finished best to prevail in a close finish from Brummagen (Ryan Bradley, \$4.20) and One Smart Cookie (Leeshelle Small, \$41)

Showers throughout the afternoon resulted in poor visibility for jockeys and the final event, the Mountain View Hotel Tooraweenah Cup was abandoned.

Run in conjunction with a Fund Raiser for Jess Tink and family, the Gilgandra meeting attracted a very big and generous crowd.



Race meetings this Saturday at Bedgerabong Picnics and Orange and next Sunday at Dubbo followed by Condobolin Picnics and Mudgee (Country Championship Qualifier, both on Saturday, February 21.



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Wellington Public School FIRST DAY OF SCHOOL



FIRST DAY BACK IN TERM 1, 2026

It has been a wonderful start to the year as we welcomed Miss Kaylie Thompson as our new Head of School and Mrs Alison Smith back in her new role as Teacher Librarian.

Across the classrooms, our students have settled in with remarkable ease:

- **Kindergarten:** Our newest students have impressed us all with their resilience and joy under the care of Mrs Roser and Mrs Campion.
- **Years 1 & 2:** Students are off to a great start with Mrs Giffin,, including a special welcome visit from Miss Thompson.
- **Years 3 & 4:** Mrs Thomas and Mrs Pottie have guided a smooth transition into Stage 2, with students quickly mastering their new routines.
- **Years 5 & 6:** Led by Mrs Woolfrey, our seniors are already showing great maturity, diving into art and public speaking with Mrs Campion.

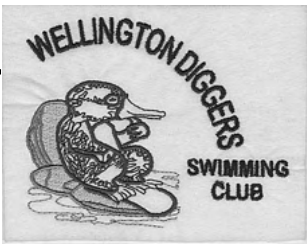
We look forward to a year filled with growth, learning, and community!



YEAR 3-6 SWIMMING CARNIVAL

Our Year 3-6 students participated in the Swimming Carnival with Year 3-12 Dubbo Christian School students at the Dubbo Aquatic Leisure Centre. Congratulations to our students who gave their very best, and to those who qualified for the Zone Swimming Carnival!





Wellington Diggers Swimming Club News

OUR TRIP to Cobar for the Western Districts AIF Championships did not meet with much success, however some good times were recorded in the pool.

Katharine O'Rourke finished third in the Ladies 50-metre Scratch Championship and our Relay Teams finished third in the 4x50 (200Years), while our 10 x 50 metre team finished fourth.

Only a small number of members participated in our weekly swim on Tuesday, February 3.

Henry Willcockson won the 3- metre event being 0.03 outside his time with Di Donnelly second and Nick Knowles third.

Katharine O'Rourke won the 50-metre event being 0.06 outside her time.

Henry Willcockson was second with Wayne Rich third. Rhylee Hill won both junior events.

Katharine O'Rourke and Nick Knowles won the Brace Relay being 0.53 outside their time.

The Platypus



More on the history of Walmer district

Compiled by Neil Wykes and published with thankful permission.

The Post Office

The First Post Office closes in 1909

I have found information on the early history of the Walmer Post Office and Telephone Exchange from articles in the Wellington Times but this is not a full history so more research is needed to provide a history of the Post Office and Telephone Exchange.

In 1903 contracts were granted to deliver mail to Walmer via Finger Post.

In July 1905 there is mention that the Farmers and Settlers Association (FSA) was trying to get a Telephone Connection to the Post Office.

In January 1908 it was announced that Mr P Trounce had resigned as Postmaster at Walmer and closed the Post Office.

It is worth noting that the Name of the Trounce Farm is "Walmer".

All of this suggests that there may have been a Post Office located on Trounce's Farm for some years up to 1908.

It also suggests that the mail then went back to what we would have known as mail delivered to roadside mailboxes (RMB).

the 23rd July last, has been inquired into, but it is found that the proposal would not be suitable for the whole line, and would be more costly than the present arrangement, for the reason that additional drivers and horses would be required for the proper maintenance of the contract.

It was considered that a diversion of this mail line at Yeoval would give better results, in as much as more suitable timetables could be arranged from the two main centres, viz, Wellington and Parkes.

This would give the settlers between Wellington and Yeoval and Parkes and Yeoval a more satisfactory services generally, and especially in regard to the distribution of the local newspapers, and also connecting, as far as practicable, with the Cumnock mail line.

It has, therefore, been decided to call for tenders for the service as at present performed, and for alternative tenders as follows: - Parkes to Yeoval, via Goobang, Mount Aubrey, and Baldry, twice weekly and Wellington to Yeoval, via Finger Post, twice weekly."

The Second Post office opens in 1925 In 1925 after the railway line to Dubbo opened it appears a new Post Office was established run by Miss Christina Pearson. This would indicate that some mail from Sydney came by train but the Roadside Mail Box deliveries continued well into the 1960's.

The Wellington Times of 9 November 1925 reported *A long needed want at Walmer has been a Post Office, and I am pleased to report that, owing to the efforts of the local F.S.A., and their energetic secretary, Mr. D. Baird, Walmer at last boasts of a daily mail service with Dubbo. This is a great boon to the "Walmerites" as before we only had a bi-weekly roadside service from the Wellington-Parkes mail. The Post Office, with public telephone*

attached is in the charge of the capable and popular Miss Cris Pearson, of 'Glencot,' who, after several applications from F.S.A. members, kindly consented to having her name sent in as applicant for the position.

Now, then, Walmer, rally, round, and repay Miss Pearson's generosity, by sending her all your correspondence to handle, and be sure boys, it's a large budget daily.

The office is only in its infancy yet, and I understand there is some little delay adopting the official stores, and a few minor matters; but no doubt in the course of a few days that will be rectified, and everything will then move smoothly in our local P.M.'s hands.

The year 1925 saw the start of the railway, the reopening of the Walmer School and the reinstatement of the Post Office.

Initially the Coonamble Mail ran via Walmer to Dubbo and dropped off mail. The first Coonamble mail to go this way was 1 June 1925.

The post office was located on the Reserve opposite the school. This was land set aside by the lands board for community use.

Location of the Post Office changes in 1937

On 1 July 1937 the Parkes Family moved to their new house at "Roselane" and were moving the post office to that address

At least from the 1950's through to the late 1960's the Post Office and telephone exchange was run by Mrs Rene Parkes. The photos below show the fibro building that housed the post office and the telephone exchange

This photo shows the Post Office and the Parkes House. In the 1950's there was a large Orchard at the front of the house and the house had rammed earth floors.



Stuart Town swim squad excels in small schools carnival

WITH JUST four swimmers in their team, Stuart Town Public School excelled in the pool at Dubbo small schools' carnival last week.



Teachers and families were overwhelmed with joy with results including Gracie Pulbrook being awarded senior girls Champion after winning seven events

Not to be outdone by the other schools, Stuart Town's Charlotte Howard was 11 Years girls champion

To top off the day Stuart Town won the relay and completed the day winning the Average Point-score, bringing home the trophy for three years in a row.

The town and district couldn't be prouder.



In Their Sights



Fashions Mount Rifle Club

Results Saturday, February 7.

Hunting Class: B. Spedding 96, R. Dowton 95.2, B. Ball 85, L. Hough 84.

500 Yards: S. King 116.6, L. Hough 113.4, J. Haberecht 110.2, B. Hollow 109, P. Kelly 89.

Next Shoot at 600 yards Saturday, February 21.

The Rifleman

Conservation farmers meet up



GROWERS, ADVISORS and the Central West Farming Systems team came together in Condobolin for a Soil Performance Discussion Group.

This was a practical, peer-to-peer session focused on how growers actually assess soil performance on farm. The discussion centred on which soil indicators matter most locally, what soil tests and observations are being used, and how these link to management decisions across different soil types and land

uses in the region.

As part of a national Soil CRC research project led by Federation University, the insights shared will be used to inform the development of a practical soil indicator interpretation tool grounded in real farming systems.

It was a great opportunity for all sectors to contribute experience and views as local input like this is critical to making sure research outputs reflect how decisions are made on farm.

Wellington Rivercare

Mid Macquarie Landcare is calling for interested people to form a Wellington Rivercare Group.

Come along to our information evening at 7pm Thursday

19th February at the Grand Hotel.

All welcome! For any enquiries please contact Landcare on 0404 255 634.

Western Swim Championships

- Carmen Gain photos

Wellington Swimmers shine at Western Area Championships

Wellington Amateur Swimming Club (WASC) has celebrated outstanding success at the Western Area Championships, with swimmers delivering an impressive performance across two days of competition. The club recorded an exceptional medal tally while also achieving numerous personal best times, highlighting the dedication and preparation of the swimmers throughout the season. The strong results contributed to WASC finishing third overall for the season, a significant achievement for the club and its athletes. Swimmers who achieved podium finishes during the Championships included Elsie Gain, Cruz Gray, Roman

and Lakyn Dowton, Imogen Jones and Ronnie Tandy Bell. The club also celebrated success in the relay events, with the Junior Relay team of Cruz, Sylvie and Pippa Laurie, Imogen, Roman and Sage Smith achieving an excellent third place finish. Several Wellington swimmers also received individual honours for their consistent performances throughout the season. Roman secured second overall in the Junior Boys division, while Lakyn achieved second overall in the Senior Boys division. Ronnie was also recognised for his efforts, placing second overall in the Multiclass division. The Championship meet itself gained further success for

Wellington swimmers. Ronnie was named Male Multi-class Swimmer of the Meet, an outstanding accomplishment that reflects his determination and competitive performances in the pool. Lakyn was also recognised for his efforts, finishing as Runner-Up Senior Boys Swimmer of the Meet. The results demonstrate the strength and depth within the Wellington club and reflect the hard work of swimmers, coaches and families throughout the season. The club continues to build a strong reputation within the region, consistently producing competitive swimmers and impressive results. **Carmen Gain**



Elsie Gain.



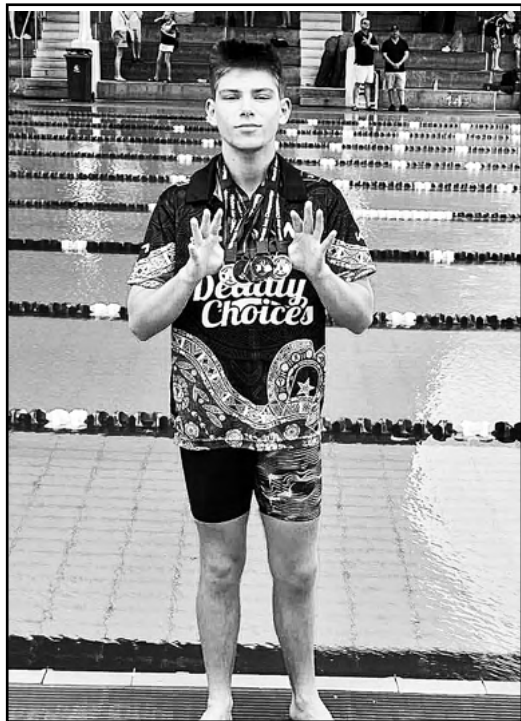
Lakyn Dowton.



Roman Dowton.



Cruz Gray.



Ronnie Tandy Bell.



Touch Footy Comp - Jo Ivey Photos

Season finals start next week in tight competition

WELLINGTON TOUCH Football returned to Pioneer Park last Wednesday night for the first round of competition following the summer break, with just two rounds remaining before finals.

In A Grade action, FORME made a statement with a dominant 14-0 victory over TMR, while Wolf Pack put in an impressive display defeating Biggest Mob 12-5.

Competition leaders Fast Eddie Owens Plumbing continued their strong form with a 4-1 win over Wellingtons Finest, and Bell River Hay edged out Ben's Tyres 7-6 in a tight contest.

B Grade's ladder leaders Lousicks extended their advantage with an 8-2 win over NF Electrical. Arthurville accounted for Let It Snow 5-3, while Deadly Reddies got the better of Morley's Earthmoving 5-3.

In the Tremain Ivey Junior Competition, C Grade leaders Wello Weapons remained on top after a hard-fought 7-5 win against Swamp Kings. Junior Cowboys were in fine form defeating Pups 9-2, and Touch Downs continued their push for finals with a convincing 6-1 win over TTG.

The Slippery Steppers kept their season alive with a 4-0 shutout of Warriors, while Too Fast Too Fabulous defeated The Whipper Snippers 5-1.

The final regular season round took place last night before finals commence next Wednesday.

Abe Dearmer



Golfing News

Kiss trophy competition nominations now open

NOMINATIONS ARE now open for the prestigious Kiss Trophy, sheets on the notice board.

There were plenty of players out last Saturday for the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club February Monthly Medal, and the Final round of the Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws Summer Competition, plus the George Hollow Putting Competition.

Winner of the A grade Monthly Medal was Kurt Cusack who put together a great round to finish with a 70nett, 66 off the stick.

Runner up was Daniel McCullum who also had a good day out to finish with a 72nett on a countback.

Winner in B grade Monthly Medal was Rod Pedron finishing with the low score of the day 69nett. Runner up award went to Cody Conn with a 71nett on a countback.

Prize winners were John Southwell, Brad Hyland, Mac Harvey, Steve Kiss 71netts, Peter Holden 72nett; Adam Ryan, Noel Stanford, Blake Ferguson, Teena Campbell, Gary Cusack, David O'Brien, Brock Naden 73netts; David Hyde, Joe Mason, Robert Baker, Paul Hannelly 74netts on c/b.

Nearest the Pin on the 3rd Ben Kiss, 8th David Hyde, 14th Blake Ferguson, 16th Joe Ryan.

George Hollow Putting Competition

winner was Kurt Cusack finishing with only 22putts.

NTP in two-shots on the 13th went to Patrick Slack-Smith.

Long drive award went to Kurt Cusack in A grade, no B grade awarded.

Brent Eather Encouragement award was taken out by Michael Britton with an 89nett which isn't too bad considering.

Wednesday's ladies day, (men are allowed to play) was an Individual Stableford, plus the 9-hole competition.

Winner of the 18-hole comp was Wendy Slack-Smith who gapped the field by plenty with her final score being 42pts., while Jan Payne was runner-up with 36pts on a countback. Prize winner was Marie Cornish 36pts.

Thursday's Individual Stableford was won by Liam Conn with an absolutely astonishing round of 46pts. Runner-up was Peter Payne on 42.

Prize winners were Steven McCarroll, Paul Hannelly 38pts; Peter Holden 37pts. Iberdrola, Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club nine-hole comp's Round 16 results: Matthew Reid conquered all with a 32nett on c/b. Runner-up was Joe Ryan also with 32nett.

Leaders after Round 16: Tim Parker took the lead -10, Ashley Bullock -9, Adam Ryan -8, Joe and David Ryan -7. Raffle

winner was Peter Payne.

Diggers Golf Club results from the last event, a two-Person Ambrose were Sarah Darney and Daniel McCullum the winners. Runners-up were Joe and Charlie Ryan.

Diggers Golf events are open to all golfers and non-golfers as well, and run every couple of weeks.

Final round of the Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws Summer Competition resulted with Bell River Bandits defeating Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws 3up, Soldiers Memorial Club lost to Snipers 1dn, Used Groceries defeated Railway Boys 2up, Kevaliers defeated Power Rangers 4up, Maulers lost to Dirt Diggers 4dn, The Masters lost to Dirty Birds 4dn, Lion of Waterloo defeated Pheonix 2up.

Final Points table: Kevaliers 49pts and claim the Minor Premiership prize, Lion of Waterloo 41.8pts, Bell River Bandits 35.9pts, Dirty Birds 35.7pts, Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws 35.2pts, Maulers 33.3pts, Pheonix 31.6pts, Masters 29.3pts, Power Rangers 27.5pts, Used Groceries 26.8pts, Soldiers Memorial Club 24.9pts, Dirt Diggers 24.7pts, Snipers 24.5pts, Railway Boys 17.1pts.

Congratulations to the eight teams that will now play the Semi-Finals.

Qualifying Finals have Kevaliers v Dirty Birds and Lion of Waterloo v Bell River



Liam Conn won Thursday's Stableford.

Bandits. Elimination Finals have Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws v Masters and Maulers v Pheonix.

Wellington Soldiers Memorial and Golf Club is Celebrating its 100 Year anniversary on Sunday, March 15, with a four-person Ambrose., and bookings are now open for teams.

While there will be no transport to the golf course, there will be plenty of transport available for your return home.

19th Hole

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